FROM THE APPENDIX TO HOW TO DATE AUTHENTICALLY

20 Questions for *Dating*

Real questions you can actually use on your next date, to get to real connection instead of just another interview.

Use one or two to start a conversation. Or make a date of asking all 20. Either way, the point is the same: listen well, stay curious, and look for a great relationship together.

SAM WHITNEY

Author of How to Date Authentically

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Listen first. The questions do the rest.

These questions are here to put you in the listening seat and give you greater insight into the person you are dating. They help you build the habit of listening, one honest answer at a time.

Three ways to use them

Start small.

Use one or two questions to kick off a conversation. You do not need to work through the list in order.

Go deeper.

When an answer interests you, say “Tell me more” or “Tell me more about that.” Then pause and listen. You can also ask the follow-up question underneath it. Follow-ups are where the real story usually shows up.

Make a date of it.

Ask all 20 questions together, taking turns. Treat it as shared discovery, not a test with correct answers.

Go deeper with three small words

You do not need a clever follow-up to go deeper. When something in an answer catches your attention, try “Tell me more” or “Tell me more about that,” and then give the other person room to answer. Do not rush to the next question, and do not jump in with your own story right away. Let a short pause do the work. Most people will share more when they feel heard, not hurried.

Three habits carry through every question: consider other people, be curious, and be straightforward. Consider what the other person might be hoping for. Stay curious about what you do not yet understand. And be honest about where you stand, kindly and clearly.

A note before you start: Apply these ideas to how you date. Do not use them to blame others or to prove a point. Your example is the most powerful way to help someone else change.

THE QUESTIONS · PART 1

Questions 1 to 10

Ask the question. Then listen. Use the follow-up only when you want to hear more.

1. **What is something good that has happened to you lately?**
   - → Why are you excited about it?
   - → What does it mean for your future?

2. **If I could give you a billion dollars, what would you do with it?**
   - → What experiences have you had that influenced why you said what you did?

3. **What are some qualities that you admire in other people?**
   - → How about in yourself?
   - → Tell me more about that.

4. **What is something that you wish other people would recognize about you?**
   - → Why do you think they don't?

5. **Can you tell me about when you had the most fun you've ever had?**
   - → Why was it so much fun for you?

6. **If you could travel the world with one person from history, who would it be and why?**
   - → Where would you go on your trip?

7. **Do you have a best friend?**
   - → Why is this person your best friend?

8. **What did you want to be when you were little?**
   - → How does your life path now match that little person's dreams?

9. **What is something you worry about?**

10. **What do you find yourself thinking about when you have free time?**
    - → Why do you think that is coming up for you?

Questions 11 to 20

Keep listening. The later questions go a little deeper, so let the other person share only what they are willing to share.

11. **What is something about you that you think others would find embarrassing?**

12. **Have you ever had your heart broken?**
    - → If you're willing to share, how has that experience shaped you?

13. **Tell me about your parents. What are they like?**
    - → What about them do you hope you can keep doing?
    - → What about them do you hope not to repeat?

14. **Have you ever eaten anything that changed your life?**

15. **What is your go-to memory when you want to feel happy?**
    - → Why this memory?

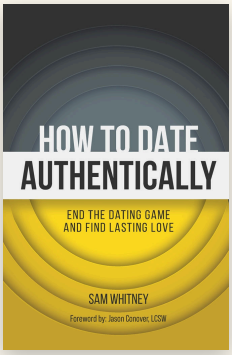
16. **What would you consider to be the biggest adventure you have had in your life so far?**

17. **If you had to leave lessons behind for future generations, what would they be?**
    - → What experiences have you had that make you say what you said?

18. **If your life were a telenovela, what would you include as the weird twist?**

19. **What do you hope to accomplish with your dating journey?**

20. **If you could solve one world problem right now, what would it be and why?**



Want to go further?

If these questions opened up a good conversation and you would like to go deeper, the ideas behind them are explored in full in *How to Date Authentically* by Sam Whitney.

Buy the book on Amazon or **check it out at rightorhappybook.com**.

Questions in this guide are from the appendix to *How to Date Authentically* by Sam Whitney. Copyright © 2024 by Sam Whitney. Shared here as a free guide for personal use.